

Word family: **lift / lifts / lifted / lifting / lifter**

Base word: lift

Past tense: lifted

Past participle: lifted

** -ing form:** lifting

Related form: lifter

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “At first, it was nothing special because we only exchanged greetings in the **lift** from time to time.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **lift** is the British English word for a **small enclosed platform or compartment that carries people or goods vertically between different floors of a building**.

繁體中文： **在建築物不同樓層之間上下運送人或物件的升降設備；電梯**

中文翻譯：

> “...we only exchanged greetings in the **lift** from time to time.”

「.....因為我們只是偶爾在**電梯**裡打招呼而已。」

Here:

lift = 電梯 / 升降機

In American English, the usual word is:

elevator

1. **lift = elevator (建築物升降設備) — 電梯；升降機**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “We only exchanged greetings in the **lift** from time to time.”

「我們只是偶爾在**電梯**裡打招呼。」

Practice 2

> “We took the **lift** to the tenth floor.”

「我們乘**電梯**到十樓。」

Practice 3

> “The **lift** is out of order, so we'll have to use the stairs.”

「**電梯**壞了，所以我們只好走樓梯。」

lift = 在建築物內垂直運送乘客或貨物到不同樓層的設備

Regional note

British English: lift

American English: elevator

> “Take the **lift** to the third floor.” 

> “Take the **elevator** to the third floor.” 

The meaning is the same.

2. **lift** + object/person (物件 / 人物) — 抬起；舉起；提起

This is the basic verb meaning.

Meaning: To move something or someone **upward** from a lower position to a higher one, usually by applying physical force.

Practice 4

> “He **lifted** the heavy box onto the table.”

「他把那個沉重的箱子**抬到桌上**。」

Practice 5

> “She **lifted** the baby out of the chair.”

「她把嬰兒從椅子上**抱起來 / 提起來**。」

****lift something = 把某物由較低的位置向上移到較高的位置****

Common examples:

- * lift a box
- * lift a bag
- * lift your hand
- * lift your head
- * lift a child
- * lift weights

These are all one underlying physical sense.

3. ****something lifts / lift something (向上升起) — 升起 ; 使升高****

Here the emphasis is not necessarily on a person physically carrying an object.

Something itself may move upward, or something may cause it to rise.

Practice 6

> “The balloon slowly ****lifted**** into the air.”

「氣球慢慢****升上空中****。」

Practice 7

> “A strong wind ****lifted**** the leaves from the ground.”

「強風吹得樹葉從地面****揚起來****。」

****lift = 向上升起 , 或使某物從原本位置向上移動****

I would treat this as closely related to the physical meaning in #2 rather than inventing a completely unrelated sense. The core idea remains:

> ****movement upward****

Under the Golden Manual, closely related contexts sharing one semantic concept should be merged rather than artificially split.

4. ****give someone a lift / get a lift (乘車) — 順便載某人一程 ; 搭便車****

This is a distinct noun meaning.

A **lift** can mean a journey in someone else's vehicle, especially when they take you somewhere as a favour.

Practice 8

> “Can you give me a **lift** to the station?”

「你可以**順便載我去車站**嗎？」

Practice 9

> “I got a **lift** home from a colleague.”

「我搭同事的車**回家 / 讓同事載我一程**。」

give someone a lift = 用自己的車順便載某人到某個地方

get a lift = 乘坐別人的車前往某個地方

Regional note

This is especially common in British English.

American English commonly uses:

> **give someone a ride**

Compare:

> “Can you give me a **lift**?” 

> “Can you give me a **ride**?” 

5. **lift a ban/restriction/rule** (禁令 / 限制) — 解除 ; 撤銷

This is an important figurative meaning.

Meaning: To officially remove a restriction, ban, rule, or limitation so that it no longer applies.

Practice 10

> “The government **lifted** the travel restrictions.”

「政府**解除了旅遊限制**。」

Practice 11

> “The ban was finally **lifted** after several months.”

「幾個月後，這項禁令終於被**解除 / 撤銷**。」

****lift a ban/restriction = 正式取消某項原本限制人們行動或選擇的規定****

Common:

- * lift a ban
- * lift restrictions
- * lift sanctions
- * lift a curfew
- * lift a limit

The figurative image is that a restriction was like a ****weight or barrier****, and it is now being removed.

6. ****lift someone's mood/spirits (情緒 / 精神) — 振奮 ; 改善心情****

Another common figurative extension.

****Meaning:**** To make someone feel ****happier, more hopeful, or more energetic****.

Practice 12

> “The good news really ****lifted her spirits****.”

「這個好消息真的令她****精神振奮 / 心情好了很多****。」

Practice 13

> “A short walk outside can ****lift your mood****.”

「到外面走一會兒可以****改善你的心情****。」

****lift someone's spirits/mood = 令人的情緒由較低落的狀態變得更愉快、積極或有精神****

The metaphor again involves ****upward movement****:

> low mood → lifted mood

But for learners, the mental/emotional interpretation is important enough to make explicit.

7. ****fog/cloud/mist lifts (霧 / 雲霧) — 消散 ; 散去****

This is a common intransitive meaning.

When fog, cloud, mist, smoke, etc. ****lifts****, it becomes less dense or disappears, allowing things to become clearer.

Practice 14

> “The fog began to ****lift**** around midday.”

「中午左右，霧開始****消散****。」

Practice 15

> “Once the mist ****lifted****, we could see the mountains clearly.”

「霧氣****散去****後，我們便可以清楚看見山脈。」

****fog/mist lifts = 原本遮擋視線的霧氣逐漸散去，使環境變得清晰****

This is different enough from physically lifting an object to deserve explicit treatment.

8. ****pressure/tension/gloom lifts (壓力 / 緊張 / 陰沉氣氛) — 減輕 ; 消退****

The same general idea can extend figuratively to unpleasant conditions.

Practice 16

> “The tension in the room slowly ****lifted****.”

「房間裡的緊張氣氛慢慢****消退了****。」

Practice 17

> “After the problem was solved, a great weight seemed to ****lift****.”

「問題解決後，那種沉重的壓力似乎終於****減輕 / 消失了****。」

****an unpleasant condition lifts = 某種壓力、緊張感或沉重氣氛逐漸減弱或消失****

I would place this together with the broader ****disappear/remove a covering or burden**** concept rather than create multiple separate meanings for ***fog***, ***tension***, ***gloom***, etc.

9. ****lift = steal (偷取) — 偷 ; 順手牽羊****

This is informal.

****Meaning:**** To steal something.

Practice 18

> “Someone ****lifted**** his phone while he was on the train.”

「有人趁他坐火車時****偷走了他的手機****。」

Practice 19

> “The thief was caught after ****lifting**** several wallets.”

「那名小偷在****偷走幾個錢包****後被捕。」

****lift something = 非正式地指偷走某件物品****

Register:

****informal****

It is not normally the safest default word for learners; ****steal**** is more neutral.

10. ****lift + words/music/design (文字 / 音樂 / 設計) — 抄用 ; 剽竊****

A related figurative use of the informal “steal” meaning is to take material from someone else's work without proper permission or acknowledgment.

Practice 20

> “Several lines were allegedly ****lifted**** from another article.”

「據稱其中幾行文字是從另一篇文章中****抄過來 / 剽竊而來的****。」

Practice 21

> “The melody sounds as though it was ****lifted**** from an older song.”

「這段旋律聽起來像是從一首較舊的歌曲中****抄來的****。」

****lift material from something** = 未經適當承認或授權，直接取用別人的文字、音樂、構思等******

I would ****not count this as entirely separate from the stealing sense**** for database purposes. It is essentially:

> ****figuratively steal creative material****

11. ****lift fingerprints/evidence** (指紋 / 證據) — 提取；取得******

This is an established police/forensic use.

Practice 22

> “Police managed to ****lift fingerprints**** from the window.”

「警方成功從窗戶上****提取到指紋****。」

Practice 23

> “Investigators ****lifted several prints**** from the glass.”

「調查人員從玻璃上****提取了幾枚指紋****。」

****lift fingerprints** = 使用技術方法從物體表面取得可供分析的指紋******

This is a domain-specific meaning but common enough in crime reporting and television to be useful to learners.

12. ****lift** = boost/improvement (提升 / 鼓舞) — 提升；改善；鼓舞******

As a noun, ****a lift**** can mean something that makes a situation, mood, performance, etc. better.

Practice 24

> “The positive review gave sales a ****lift****.”

「正面的評論令銷售表現得到**提升**。」

Practice 25

> “The good news gave everyone a much-needed **lift**.”

「這個好消息給大家帶來了十分需要的**鼓舞 / 振奮**。」

****a lift = 令情況、情緒或表現有所改善或提升的作用****

This corresponds closely to the verb:

> ****lift someone's spirits****

Important distinction: ****lift vs raise****

Both can involve upward movement.

****lift****

Often focuses on physically moving something upward:

> “She ****lifted**** the box.”

「她把箱子抬起來。」

****raise****

Often means making something higher, and can apply very broadly:

- > raise prices
- > raise taxes
- > raise standards
- > raise your hand

So:

> ****lift a box**** = 把箱子抬起來

but:

> ****raise the price**** = 提高價格

Although overlap exists, they are not freely interchangeable.

Important distinction: **lift** vs **elevator**

British English

> **lift**

American English

> **elevator**

For your passage, which uses British-style English:

> “in the **lift**”

= **在電梯裡**

This is a regional vocabulary difference, not a semantic difference.

Important distinction: **lift** vs **carry**

lift

focuses on **upward movement**

> “Lift the bag off the floor.”

「把袋子從地上提起來。」

carry

focuses on **supporting and moving something from one place to another**

> “Carry the bag into the kitchen.”

「把袋子拿到廚房。」

You can therefore:

> **lift** a suitcase

without necessarily carrying it anywhere.

Important distinction: **lift** a ban vs remove an object

These share the broader idea of removal, but grammatically and semantically the context differs.

> “They **lifted** the box.”

= physically moved it upward

> “They **lifted** the ban.”

= officially removed the restriction

A learner who only knows the physical meaning could easily misunderstand the second sentence, so the figurative sense deserves its own entry under the SOP.

Family-extension note

Useful family members and compounds include:

- * **lift**
- * **lifted**
- * **lifting**
- * **lifter**
- * **weightlifting**
- * **weightlifter**
- * **forklift**
- * **ski lift**
- * **chairlift**
- * **face-lift / facelift**

These should not all be treated as additional meanings of bare **lift**.

For example:

forklift

= a powered vehicle with projecting forks used to raise and move heavy goods

ski lift

= equipment that transports skiers uphill

weightlifting

= the sport/activity of lifting heavy weights

facelift

literally:

= cosmetic surgery intended to make the face look younger

figuratively:

= improvements made to the appearance of a building, product, website, etc.

> “The website has been given a **facelift**.”

「這個網站的外觀經過了**翻新 / 重新設計**。」

Under the Golden Manual, these are useful family extensions and compounds rather than automatically being numbered as meanings of the base word.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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lift — elevator	在建築物不同樓層之間垂直運送人或物件的升降設備；電梯 / 升降機
lift something — physically raise	把人或物件從較低的位置向上移到較高的位置
give/get a lift	用車順便載某人一程 / 乘坐別人的車前往某地
lift a ban/restriction	正式取消原本限制行動、活動或選擇的規定
lift someone's spirits/mood	令人的情緒變得更愉快、積極或有精神
fog/mist lifts	原本遮擋視線的霧氣逐漸消散，使環境重新清晰
tension/gloom lifts	原本沉重、緊張或不愉快的狀態逐漸減弱或消失
lift — steal	非正式地指偷取別人的物品
lift material from something	未經適當承認而取用別人的文字、音樂或創作內容；屬於「偷取」的延伸
lift fingerprints	使用技術方法從物件表面提取可供分析的指紋
a lift — boost	令情緒、表現或整體情況有所改善或提升的作用

For your original sentence

> “We only exchanged greetings in the **lift** from time to time.”

The exact meaning is:

****lift = 在建築物內運送人或物件上下不同樓層的設備****

So:

****in the lift = 在電梯 / 升降機裡****

For the database, I would count ****9 useful core polysemy/polyfunctionality meanings**** for ****lift****:

1. ****elevator****
2. ****physically raise/move upward****
3. ****a ride in someone's vehicle****
4. ****remove a ban/restriction****
5. ****improve someone's mood/spirits****
6. ****fog/tension/etc. clears or disappears****
7. ****steal****
8. ****extract fingerprints/evidence****
9. ****noun — boost/improvement****

I would ****merge**** *lift creative material* into the ****steal**** sense, and I would merge literal upward variants such as *lift a box / leaves lift / lift your hand* under the broader physical ****move upward**** concept.